

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Nvidia paused some deals** in a new financing initiative that offered credit support to artificial-intelligence cloud providers in exchange for a share of revenue. **B1**
- ◆ **Investors confident** of tech's prospects helped drive up major U.S. stock indexes, lifting the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow industrials by 0.7%, 1.6% and 0.2%, respectively. **B9**
- ◆ **A federal judge ruled** the Trump administration violated Anthropoic's First Amendment rights by blacklisting the company as a supply-chain risk. **A2**
- ◆ **Boston Fed President** Susan Collins said she could support raising interest rates at a future meeting if data show inflation isn't declining in line with her expectations. **A2**
- ◆ **The Abu Dhabi royal** sometimes referred to as the "spy sheikh" is a major shareholder backing a new U.S. bank the Trump family's crypto venture is preparing to launch. **A1**
- ◆ **Kalshi said it aims** to broaden its weather-predictions markets with meteorological know-how from the Weather Co., which now verifies outcomes on climate trades. **B1**
- ◆ **Barret Zoph, the** Thinking Machines Lab co-founder who abruptly defected to OpenAI this year, will now join Alphabet's Google as a vice president of research. **B4**
- ◆ **DeepSeek is set** to secure new funding that would value the Chinese artificial-intelligence startup at \$74 billion, building its war chest as it aims for an IPO next year. **B1**
- ◆ **Kioxia and Sandisk** plan to invest more than \$31 billion in Japan to boost memory-chip production. **B4**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Some U.S. companies** with close ties to Trump are taking steps to gain favor with Democrats, worried that they will become targets if Republicans lose control of the House. **A1**
- ◆ **Federal aviation officials** found that two air-traffic controllers left work early before an Air Canada regional jet crashed into a firetruck at LaGuardia Airport in March. **A1**
- ◆ **Investigators said** the temporary relocation of Marine One's landing zone due to White House construction was a factor in a safety incident involving the helicopter carrying the president. **A4**
- ◆ **Trump signed** an executive order to change the name of Lake Ontario to "Lake America" in a further escalation of the U.S. trade dispute with Canada. **A3**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** is in advanced talks with Venezuela for the U.S. to take a direct stake in more than a dozen oil fields that house nearly one-third of the country's energy reserves. **A8**
- ◆ **A federal judge issued** a temporary restraining order that stops the government from implementing new rules upending mail-in voting procedures ahead of midterm elections. **A3**

- ◆ **The Trump administration** curtailed the ability of international students to complete internships before they graduate, which may hasten enrollment declines. **A3**

- ◆ **Died: Ratko Mladic, 84,** former Bosnian Serb general convicted of genocide for his role in the '90s Yugoslav wars. **A7**

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More Than 1,450 Missing in Himalayan Floods



DELUGE: Houses lie covered in sludge in Devighat in Nepal's Nuwakot District on Thursday, a day after the area was hit by a giant wave likely triggered by a broken glacier. At least 390 people died and dozens of U.S. tourists remain missing. **A7**

Two Controllers Cut Out Early Before Deadly LaGuardia Crash

By Andrew Tangel

Federal aviation officials have found that two air-traffic controllers left work early before an Air Canada regional jet crashed into a firetruck at LaGuardia Airport in March. The Federal Aviation Administration is moving to fire the two controllers, who officials determined had left about an hour before their shifts ended on March 22, people familiar with the matter

said. As a result, two controllers remaining at the LaGuardia tower didn't have backup to assist with high workloads. The busy New York City airport was handling more than twice the usual volume of traffic the night of the accident. Two pilots died in the runway collision, and six other people—including a crew member, passengers and workers on the ground—sustained serious injuries, according to the National Transportation Safety Board.

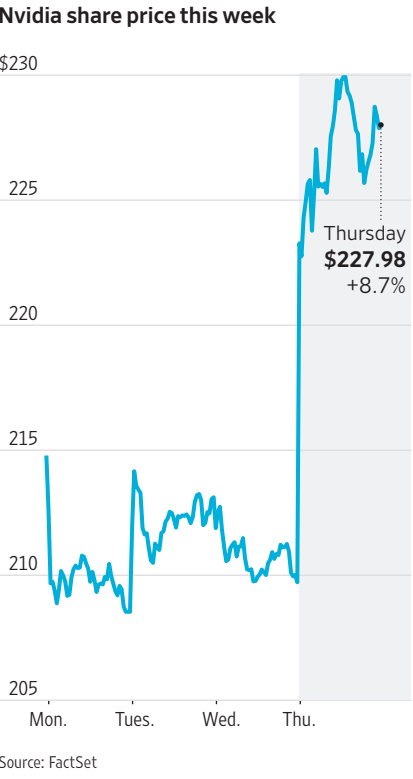
Leaving early is called an "early shove," according to current and former controllers, and is a longstanding practice in the industry. FAA officials consider it a form of timecard fraud. The push to fire the controllers signals an aggressive response to the practice by the Trump administration. Current and former controllers said managers have often condoned their leaving before their shifts officially end, and

it is seen as an informal perk after busy stretches working air traffic. The agency has taken steps this year to terminate more than 10 controllers for alleged timecard fraud or abuse of leave policies, according to people familiar with the matter. The FAA said in April that it had about 11,000 fully certified controllers. *Please turn to page A6*

◆ **Construction called factor in Marine One incident... A4**

Nvidia Fuels New AI Hopes

Nvidia's blowout second-quarter results sent the chip maker's shares surging 8.7% on Thursday, their steepest one-day jump since April 2025, adding \$442 billion to the company's market value. That rise trails only a \$450 billion one-day gain by Microsoft in July, the largest such jump ever. The quarterly report quelled worries over chip demand. **B9**



Thieving, Face-Licking Marmots Are Spreading Terror on the Trail

Cute but destructive rodents swipe shoes, snatch backpacks and guzzle radiator fluid

By Jim Carlton

MINERAL KING VALLEY, Calif.—Andrew Reinhart was so tired after hiking up a mountain pass last month, he laid down for a nap—only to wake to a wet tongue on his ear. A marmot stared back. “It scared the s— out of me,” said the 28-year-old engineer from Livermore, Calif. “You don’t expect to get licked when you go to sleep in the woods.” Welcome to Sequoia National Park, also known as Marmot Country. Yellow-bellied marmots are stalking hikers and campers in a park more famous for its namesake giant trees. They snatch backpacks, swipe shoes and nibble on trekking poles. Some even

chase humans. Jeff Weit, 66, now ties his shoes together at camp after a marmot stole one on a previous trip. He looked around to find the missing shoe and noticed one of the plump rodents sneaking peeks at him from behind a log. “I reached underneath the log and there was my shoe!” the Atascadero, Calif., resident warned before heading out on a multiday trek. “You have to treat your shoes like bear food.” Nitin Gupta, 31, watched a “quite big” marmot steal his hiking pole—then charge his girlfriend when she tried to retrieve it. “I heard this almost war cry,” the San Francisco founder recalled. *Please turn to page A10*

Costa Rican Drug Violence Sparks Political Turmoil

A bastion of democratic stability faces trafficking surge

By Ian Lovett

LIMÓN, Costa Rica—Once a beacon of democratic stability in a region beset by lawlessness, Costa Rica is facing a surge in drug violence that threatens to upend the country's political system. With homicides up 50% since 2020—putting the country's murder rate on par with Mexico's—Costa Rican President Laura Fernández and her ruling party are blaming the independent judiciary. “Why has this turned into a vicious cycle, where the police arrest people and the judiciary releases them?” Fernández said shortly after taking office in May. Her battle with the judicial branch has since exploded into a political civil war. Fernández accused the judiciary of being in-

filtrated by organized crime, filed a criminal complaint against judges of the constitutional court in a fight over judicial appointments and slashed the judiciary's budget. Judicial-branch officials and opposition politicians say Fernández and her party are making a raw power grab. Throngs of Costa Ricans took to the street this month in a show of support for the judicial branch, waving signs with messages like, “We are afraid of dictatorship” and “Don't touch our independent judiciary.” “This definitely benefits organized crime,” said Carlo Díaz, Costa Rica's attorney general, adding that proposed cuts to the judiciary's budget “could create chaos that would facilitate government decisions aimed at limiting citizens' rights.” *Please turn to page A10*

Abu Dhabi ‘Spy Sheikh’ Is a Major Shareholder In Trumps’ New Bank

The Abu Dhabi royal sometimes referred to as the “spy sheikh” is a major shareholder backing a new U.S. bank the Trump family's cryptocurrency venture is preparing to launch, according to people familiar with the matter.

By Rebecca Ballhaus, Sam Kessler and Angus Berwick

Sheikh Tahnoon bin Zayed al Nahyan and co-investors are behind an entity that owns the largest stake—49%—in the holding company that World Liberty Financial created to house its banking venture, according to people familiar with the matter. The sheikh last year backed a \$500 million investment into World Liberty Financial in exchange for a

49% stake, The Wall Street Journal reported. The Office of the Comptroller of the Currency this month granted preliminary conditional approval for World Liberty Financial to launch a federally chartered national trust bank to issue, redeem and safeguard USD1, the dollar-backed stablecoin World Liberty launched last year. The new venture marks an expansion of the business relationship between the Trump-backed crypto company and a foreign government official. Tahnoon serves as the United Arab Emirates' national security adviser and is brother to the country's president. He oversees a more than \$1.3 trillion empire funded by his personal fortune and state money. *Please turn to page A4*

President’s Corporate Donors Now Court Democrats

Tech firms fear GOP might lose House; they are preparing for potential probes

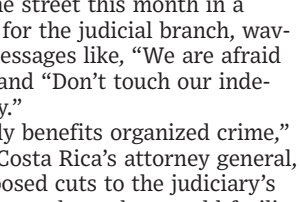
By Annie Linskey and Emily Glazer

Some U.S. companies with close ties to President Trump are taking steps to gain favor with Democrats, worried they will become targets if Republicans lose control of the House. Big tech companies, in particular those that made major donations to Trump's legacy projects, are preparing for congressional and even potential criminal investigations, according to advisers, lobbyists and board members. Washington-based lawyers and lobbyists said that their clients are asking: What are our vulnerabilities? Meta Platforms and others are writing big checks for Democrats ahead of the midterms, according to people familiar with the matter, a counterbalance to the tens of millions of dollars they gave to the White House ballroom and Republican initiatives. Other companies, including Paramount Skydance and Kalshi, are hiring former Democratic aides to bolster their government-relations efforts. Some companies are creating internal task forces to game out responses to potential congressional inquiries, particularly regarding their substantial financial support for Trump and his political operations, according to people involved in the discussions. *Please turn to page A6*

INSIDE

BUSINESS & FINANCE

The \$2 billion brawl over a green-energy company's ruinous wood-pellet trade. **B1**



MANSION

How a couple turned their Pound Ridge, N.Y., home into a luxury retreat for Buster. **M1**

